Appendix 1 Provider cohort selection log

This appendix records how the final 20-provider cohort was selected from the frozen ClusterMAX 2.1 Bronze and Silver frame. The main chapter explains the selection method; the tables below preserve the full selection record.

Table A1-1 Cohort construction summary

Selection stage	Providers	Interpretation
Initial ClusterMAX 2.1 Bronze/Silver frame	35	12 Silver and 23 Bronze providers
Hyperscalers excluded	2	AWS and Google Cloud
Broad general-cloud context excluded	2	IBM Cloud and DigitalOcean
Eligible non-hyperscaler candidate pool	31	10 Silver and 21 Bronze providers
Final cohort	20	10 Silver and 10 Bronze providers
Reserve candidates	11	Eligible Bronze providers not retained in the final cohort

Source: author's compilation based on SemiAnalysis (2026) and the cohort-selection workbook.

The priority number records the preliminary order used during sample selection. It is not a provider-performance result.

Table A1-2 Full provider selection log

Provider	Tier	Scope classification	AI/GPU relevance precheck	Public-evidence precheck	Comparability with study scope	Outcome	Priority
Together.ai	Silver	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	High	Yes	Selected	3
Lambda	Silver	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	High	Yes	Selected	2
Google Cloud	Silver	Excluded: hyperscaler	High; hyperscaler context	High	No - hyperscaler scale/model	Excluded	
AWS	Silver	Excluded: hyperscaler	High; hyperscaler context	High	No - hyperscaler scale/model	Excluded	
Scaleway	Silver	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	High	Yes	Selected	7
Cirrascale	Silver	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	Medium	Yes	Selected	16
Vultr	Silver	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	High	Yes	Selected	5
Voltage Park	Silver	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	Medium	Yes	Selected	6
Gcore	Silver	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	High	Yes	Selected	12
Firmus / SMC	Silver	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	High	Yes	Selected	1
GMO GPU Cloud	Silver	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	Medium	Yes	Selected	9
TensorWave	Silver	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	High	Yes	Selected	8
CUDO Compute	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	Medium/High; different GPU access model	Medium	Partial - marketplace/aggregation model	Reserve	
Hyperstack / NexGen	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	Medium	Yes	Reserve	

Shadeform	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	Medium/High; different GPU access model	Medium	Partial - marketplace/aggregation model	Selected	17
Neysa	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	Medium	Yes	Selected	19
STN	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	Low	Partial - bare-metal/HPC/dedicated model	Reserve	
GMI Cloud	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	Medium	Yes	Selected	15
RunPod	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	High	Yes	Reserve	
Prime Intellect	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	Medium	Yes	Selected	10
Core42 / G42	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	High	Yes	Selected	4
Bitdeer AI	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	Medium	Yes	Selected	14
FPT AI Factory	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	Medium	Yes	Selected	13
Qubrid	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	Low	Yes	Reserve	
Latitude.sh	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	Medium	Partial - bare-metal/HPC/dedicated model	Reserve	
Lightning AI	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	Medium/High; different GPU access model	High	Yes	Selected	20
Verda / DataCrunch	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	Medium	Yes	Selected	11
Denvr Dataworks	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	Medium	Partial - bare-metal/HPC/dedicated model	Reserve	
IBM Cloud	Bronze	Context only: broad general cloud	Medium; broad enterprise-cloud context	High	Partial - broader cloud model	Excluded	

DigitalOcean	Bronze	Context only: broad general cloud	Medium; broad developer-cloud context	High	Partial - broader cloud model	Excluded	
Atlas Cloud	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	Low	Yes	Reserve	
Hot Aisle	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	Low	Yes	Reserve	
BuzzHPC	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	Low	Yes	Reserve	
Vast.ai	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	Medium/High; different GPU access model	High	Partial - marketplace/aggregation model	Reserve	
Radiant / Ori	Bronze	Eligible non-hyperscaler	High	Medium	Yes	Selected	18

Source: author's compilation based on SemiAnalysis (2026) and the project workbook ClusterMAX Bronze/Silver Longlist and Sample Selection Frame.

High, Medium, and Low are preliminary selection prechecks. Partial comparability indicates a different service model, such as a marketplace or dedicated-infrastructure model.